RHYTHM READERS

Day 2 · Steady beat and reading rhythm · no tech, no prep

DAY 2

Sub plan

GOAL
Students keep a steady beat and read and clap simple rhythms with rhythm syllables.

YOU NEED
Pencils, the worksheets, the rhythm chart (page 5). No music reading needed: the syllables are printed under every note.

COPIES
K–2: page 10
3–5: page 11
about 40 min

STEP BY STEP · Italic lines are words you can say.

5 min Step 1

COPY THE BEAT

Pat a slow, steady beat on your legs. Say: *"Copy me!"* Switch to clapping, then tapping shoulders, at the same speed. Say: *"This steady pulse is called the beat."*

10 min Step 2

RHYTHM CHART ECHOES

Show the rhythm chart (page 5) or copy one line at a time on the board. Clap and say a line; the class echoes. **ta** = one clap, **ti-ti** = two quick claps in one beat, **shh** = a silent beat (open hands), **ta-a** = one clap held for 2 beats. K–2 use lines 1–4; 3–5 use all 8.

15 min Step 3

WORKSHEET

K–2 Rhythm Readers (page 10): read Part B aloud. **3–5** Rhythm Math (page 11). Answer keys are on page 22.

10 min Step 4

POISON RHYTHM

Pick one chart line as the poison rhythm and show it. Clap other lines; the class echoes. When you clap the poison rhythm, everyone stays silent. Anyone who claps it becomes a judge. Change the poison line each round.

PREVIEW

Extra time? Let students take turns as the leader for Poison Rhythm. **Short class?** Shorten step 2 to lines 1–4 and keep the worksheet.

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MUSIC SUB PLANS

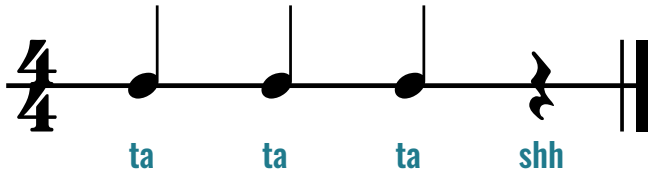
Rhythm chart · show it or copy a line on the board

FOR THE SUB

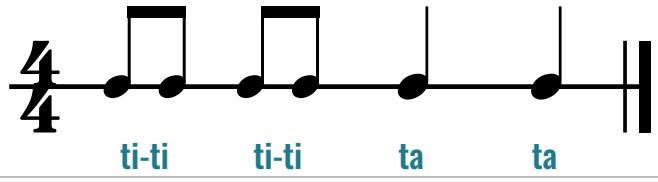
Days 2, 4 and 5

Clap and say each line; the class echoes. Say the words under the notes; you do not need to read music. Silent beats (**shh**): open your hands, no sound.

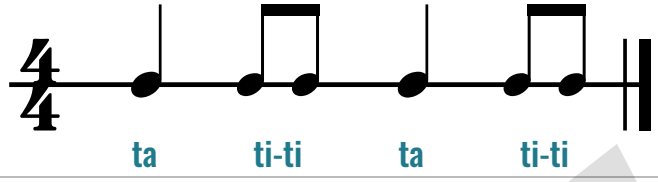
1 K–5



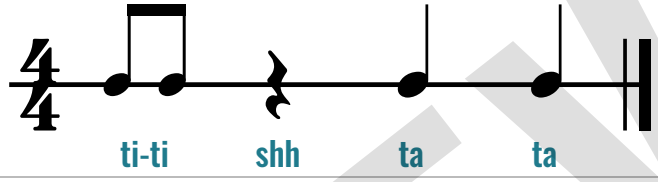
2 K–5



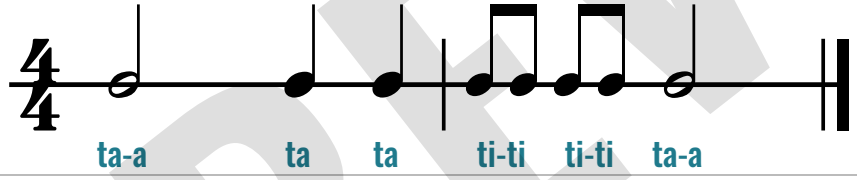
3 K–5
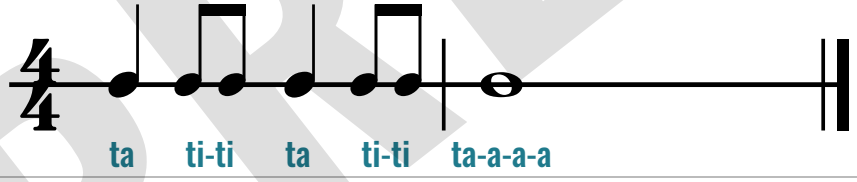


4 K–5



5 3–5



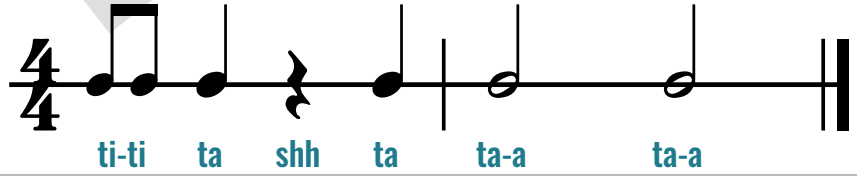
6 3–5



7 3–5



8 3–5



ta = quarter note (1 beat) · **ti-ti** = two eighth notes (1 beat) · **shh** = quarter rest (1 beat) · **ta-a** = half note (2 beats) · **ta-a-a-a** = whole note (4 beats)

PREVIEW

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DYNAMICS AND TEMPO

Match the symbols, order the tempos, mark the dynamics

DAY 3

Grades 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

A · DYNAMICS MATCH

Write the letter of the meaning next to each symbol.

1	*pp*	☐
2	*p*	☐
3	*mp*	☐
4	*mf*	☐
5	*f*	☐
6	*ff*	☐
7	<	☐
8	>	☐

A very loud (fortissimo)

B medium soft (mezzo piano)

C get softer little by little (decrescendo)

D very soft (pianissimo)

E get louder little by little (crescendo)

F soft (piano)

G loud (forte)

H medium loud (mezzo forte)

B · TEMPO LADDER

Number the tempos from 1 (slowest) to 6 (fastest).

☐ *allegro* · fast and lively

☐ *largo* · very slow and broad

☐ *moderato* · medium speed

☐ *presto* · very fast

☐ *adagio* · slow

☐ *andante* · walking speed

Tempo words are Italian. Composers write them at the start of a piece so every musician plays at the same speed.

C · BE THE COMPOSER

Write a dynamic (pp, p, mp, mf, f, ff) for each line of this chant. Then say it that way.

_____ *Hear the thunder rumble,*

_____ *feel the raindrops fall,*

_____ *now the storm is passing,*

_____ *quiet, after all.*

PREVIEW

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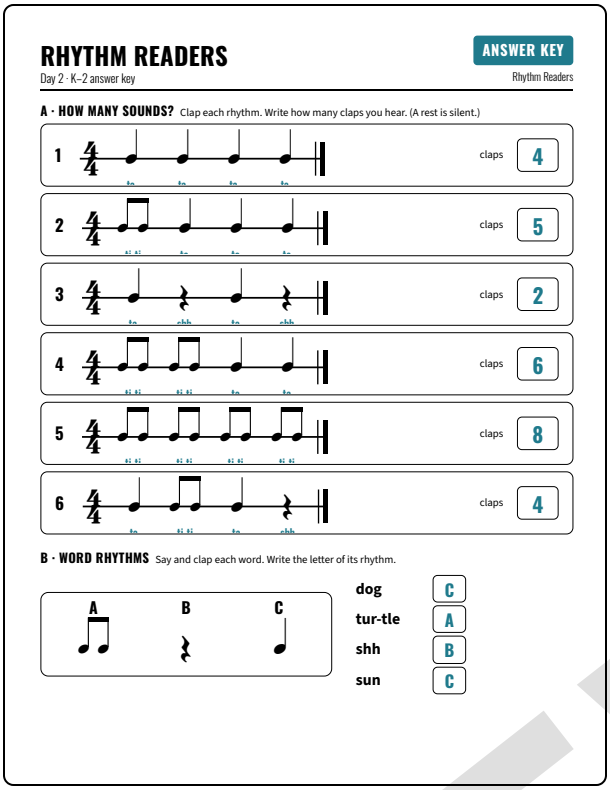
MUSIC SUB PLANS

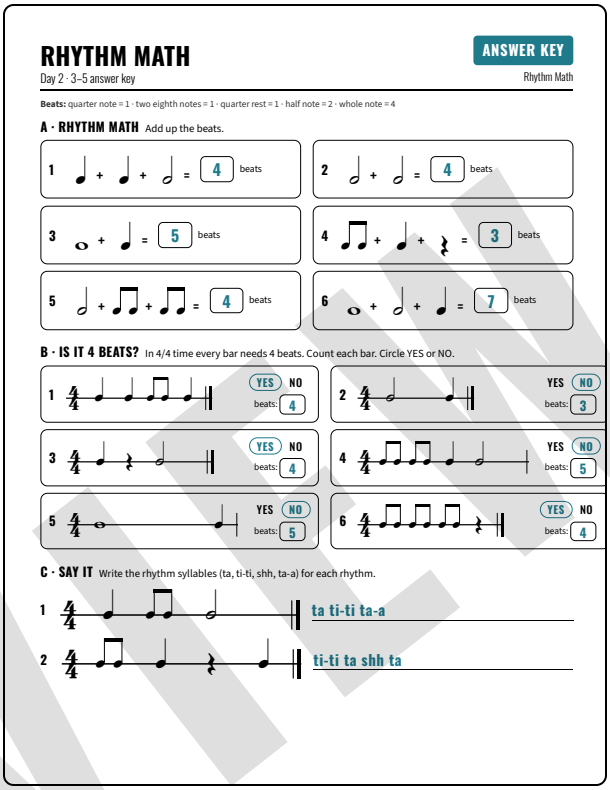
Answer keys · Day 2 Rhythm Readers and Rhythm Math

ANSWER KEY

Day 2

Day 2 answers. The small pages are the filled-in worksheets; the tables list every answer.





K–2	RHYTHM	ANSWER
A1	ta ta ta ta	4
A2	ti-ti ta ta ta	5
A3	ta shh ta shh	2
A4	ti-ti ti-ti ta ta	6
A5	ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti	8
A6	ta ti-ti ta shh	4
B · dog	ta	C
B · tur-tle	ti-ti	A
B · shh	shh	B
B · sun	ta	C

3–5	WORK	ANSWER
A1	1 + 1 + 2	4
A2	2 + 2	4
A3	4 + 1	5
A4	1 + 1 + 1	3
A5	2 + 1 + 1	4
A6	4 + 2 + 1	7
B1	ta ta ti-ti ta	YES · 4
B2	ta-a ta	NO · 3
B3	ta shh ta-a	YES · 4
B4	ti-ti ti-ti ta ta-a	NO · 5
B5	ta-a-a-a ta	NO · 5
B6	ti-ti ti-ti ti-ti shh	YES · 4
C1	ta ti-ti ta-a	
C2	ti-ti ta shh ta	

PREVIEW

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